THE EMERGING B-TOWN: WHAT MAKES BHUBANESWAR THE GO-TO PLACE FOR INDUSTRIES?

TAKEAWAYS

1. Growth model based on welfare-oriented governance, robust infrastructure, value addition to raw materials and natural resources, and market-friendly policies
2. Around 11 per cent of India's highly skilled workforce is from the state
3. Odisha eased land availability for projects along with support infrastructure, such as the four-lane road network in the iron ore mining belt in Jagatsinghpur
4. Revenue from mining rose from Rs 14,000 crore in 2020-21 to Rs 40,000 crore in 2021-22. GST collections in 2021-22 are the highest yet
5. Tourism projects fast-tracked; 60 projects worth Rs 2,400 crore cleared in past three years





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▲ THE ODISHA WAY OF DISASTER MANAGEMENT: CAN IT BE A LESSON FOR OTHER STATES?

TAKEAWAYS

1. Odisha set up India's first Disaster Management Authority. It has its own disaster response force and even a disaster management app
2. A pocketbook of guidelines, incorporating experiences from eight past cyclones for officials
3. Regular disaster-preparedness drills. Every natural disaster is followed by review and assessment
4. Malnutrition addressed as a silent emergency, helping curb cases of stunting
5. Exchange of disaster-related information and technology with other states

plan which will not only ensure piped water connection to every household, but also guarantee access to safe tap water as a fundamental right. Indeed, Puri has become the first city in India to provide 24-hour piped water supply to every household.

In the field of art and culture too, Odisha needs to reinvent itself. Repackaging, rebranding and robust marketing can help restore the state's lost glory. It took national award winning film director Nila Madhab Panda 10 years to recover the costs of his masterpiece, *I am Kalam*.

Steeped as it is in mythology, culture and its treasure trove of temple architecture, Odisha has never been overzealous in its religious beliefs or ideals. Pluralism, respect and tolerance for the other are what make Odisha the *kalabhoomi* of a myriad emotions and ideas. The secular fabric is deeply entrenched in the ecosystem of the state.

As R. Balakrishnan, chief advisor at the chief minister's office (CMO) points out, Odisha is a tropical rainforest, a happy amalgamation of forest cover, animals, birds, bees, insects and humans, an ecosystem where ideas and identities get enriched instead of getting lost in the proverbial melting pot. ■